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MessagePanelDefTopic

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About the Message Panel

About the Message Panel

The Message Panel is a component of several IG-XL tools. It provides a convenient way to display the history of messages generated during a tool session without interrupting your work flow by requiring you to click OK after each message.

The following is a summary of the Message Panel features. For more information, see Using the Message Panel. The features are as follows:

- The Message Panel has an Auto-Hide feature. It stays out of sight as a tab on the tool, but is exposed when a new message arrives or when you hover over the tab. It is hidden again when you move focus back to the tool.

- You can turn off Auto-Hide so that the panel remains visible at all times. You can dock the panel to a non-default position or make it float.
- You can sort, resize, and reorder the Message Panel columns.
- You can copy grid, row or cell content to the clipboard.
- You can filter messages by type: error, warning, and informational.
- Complex messages are represented by a summary description, with the complete details accessible through a button.
- The Message Panel places new incoming messages at the top of the list and scrolls to them, unless you turn off scrolling. Each message includes a timestamp.
- Messages remain displayed for historical reference during the tool session, although you can manually clear the list at any time.

Not all messages from the tool appear in the Message Panel. If the tool requires an immediate user action or decision, a message box appears: you must respond to the message box before you can continue working with the tool. For example, if you use the tool to make modifications to a file and then try to exit without saving your work, the tool displays a message box asking if you want to save the changes. You cannot do anything else until you respond to the message box.

Messages that do not require an immediate user response are sent to the Message Panel. When a new message arrives, the Message Panel appears showing the message and then disappears when you resume work on the tool. You do not need to dismiss or acknowledge the message explicitly. (Previously, these messages would be displayed in a message box with only the OK button. You needed to click OK to dismiss the message box.)

The Message Panel is therefore optimized for use with a tool in a debugging environment, because messages appear and disappear without explicit user action. The messages that appear become part of the session's messaging history. To look at the history, you move the pointer over the Messages tab. You can pin the panel to disable the Auto-Hide features. You can filter the messages and search for specific text in them. You can copy messages to the clipboard. The messages are therefore available when you need them but do not interfere with your work when you do not need them.

		
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MessagePanelUsing.2.1



Using the Message Panel

Using the Message Panel

The section describes how to use the Message Panel, covering these topics:

- [Message Panel Positioning Options](#)
- [Controlling the Display](#)
- [Message Panel Toolbar](#)



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MessagePanelUsing.2.2



Using the Message Panel : Message Panel Positioning Options

Message Panel Positioning Options

This section describes the basic options for positioning the Message Panel in relation to a tool:

- [Auto-Hide Feature](#)
- [Keeping the Panel Visible](#)
- [Dismissing the Panel](#)

For information on controlling the display of information within the panel, see [Controlling the Display](#).



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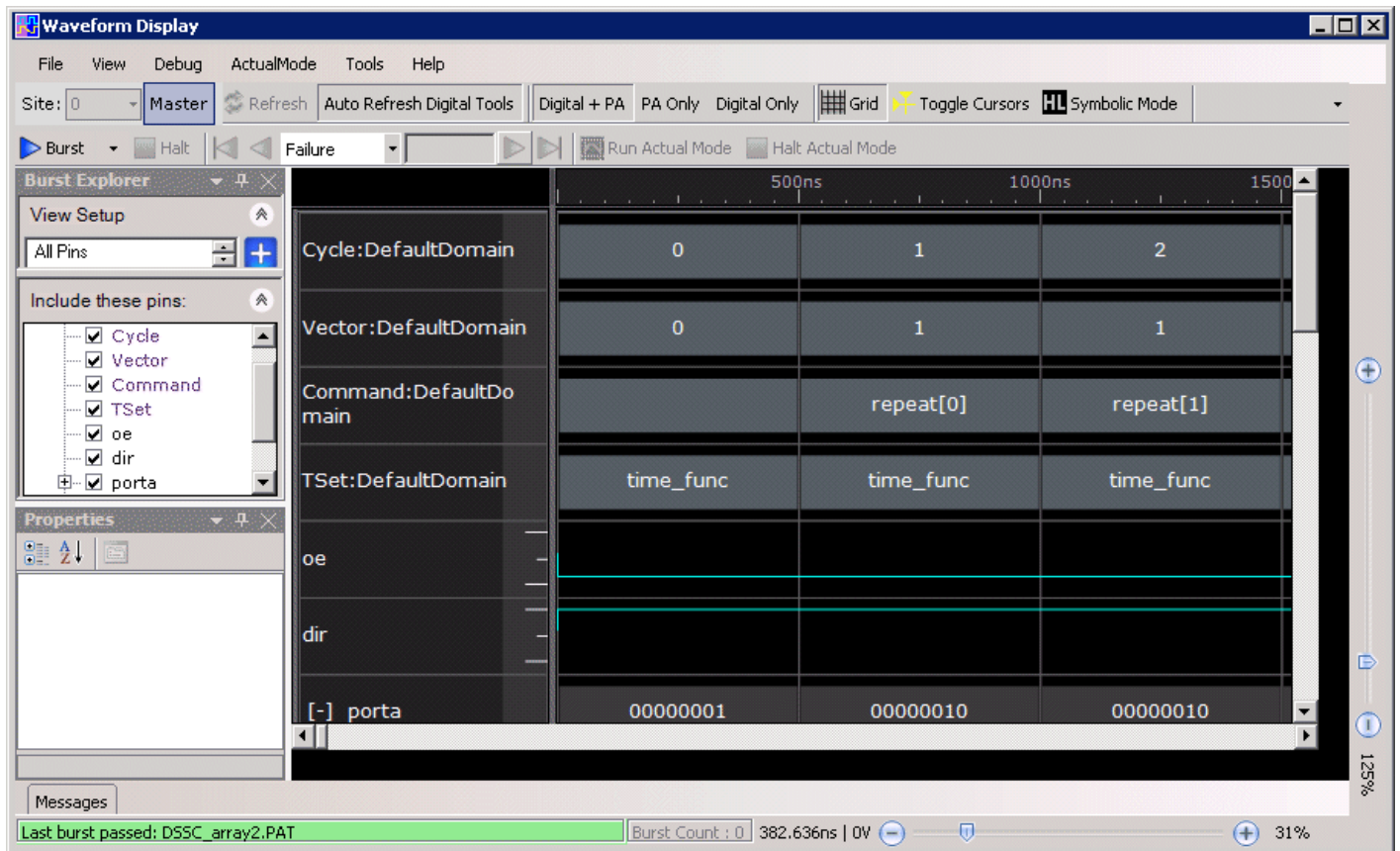
MessagePanelUsing.2.3



Using the Message Panel : [Message Panel Positioning Options](#) : Auto-Hide Feature

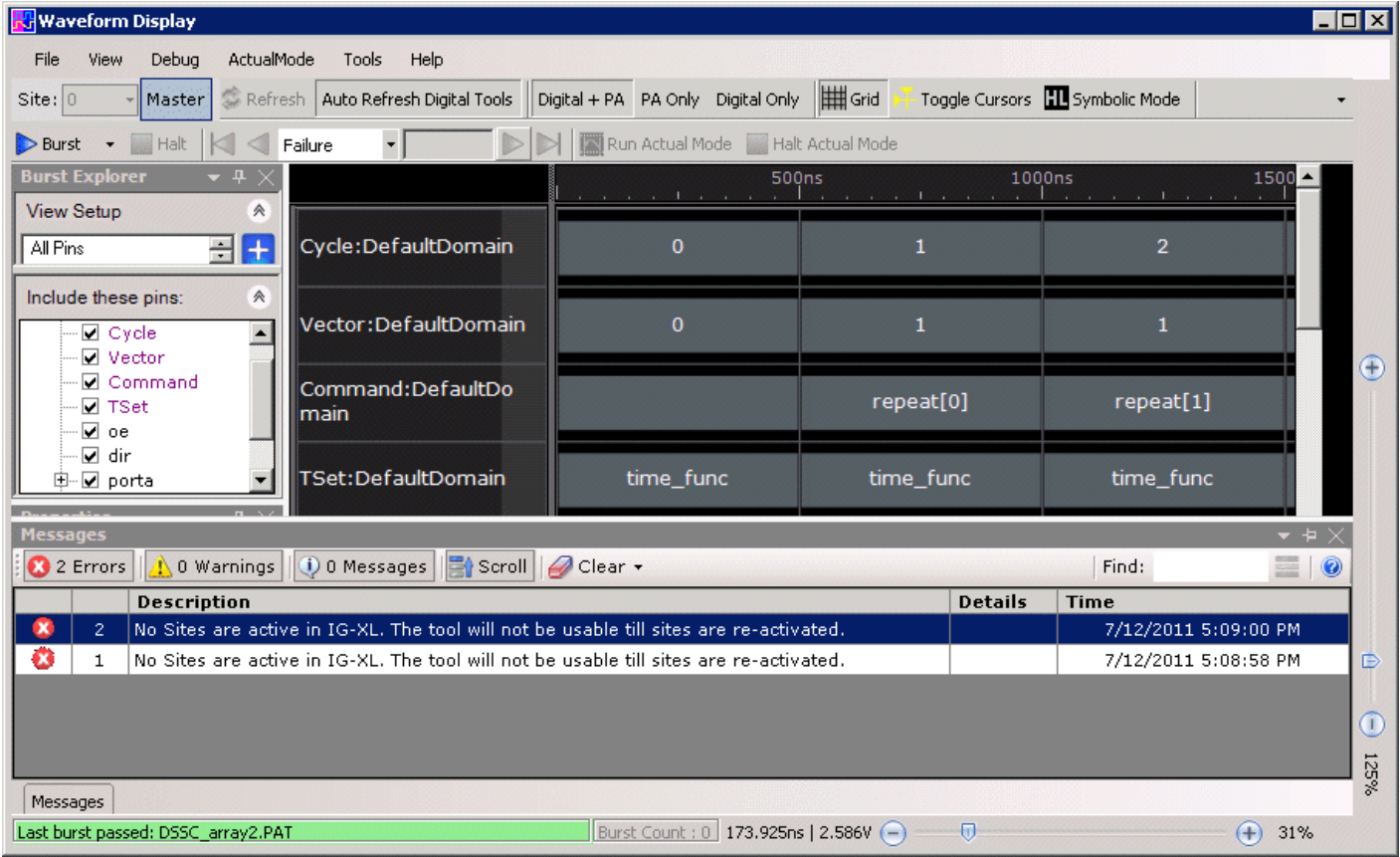
Auto-Hide Feature

By default, the Message Panel has its Auto-Hide feature turned on. The Panel, when it is not active, appears as a tab labelled Messages or Message Display Panel in the lower left corner of the tool window:



Waveform Display Showing the Messages Tab

The Message Panel becomes visible when a new message arrives or when you pass the pointer over the tab, indicating that you want to see the panel:



Waveform Display Showing the Messages Panel

Once you continue working (for example, by continuing typing, clicking anywhere else in the tool window, or moving the pointer away) the Message Panel is hidden again, returning to the tab. You can turn Auto-Hide off so that the panel remains visible at all times. See Keeping the Panel Visible.

If you dock the panel to a different position and then turn Auto-Hide on, the tab appears on the side of the window at which you have docked the panel.

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Using the Message Panel : [Message Panel Positioning Options](#) : Keeping the Panel Visible

Keeping the Panel Visible

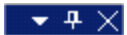
By default, Auto-Hide is turned on. See [Auto-Hide Feature](#). You can turn Auto-Hide off so that the panel is always visible. You do this by pinning the panel.

When the pin icon in the upper right corner is horizontal, pointing to the left, the panel is not pinned, and Auto-Hide is turned on:



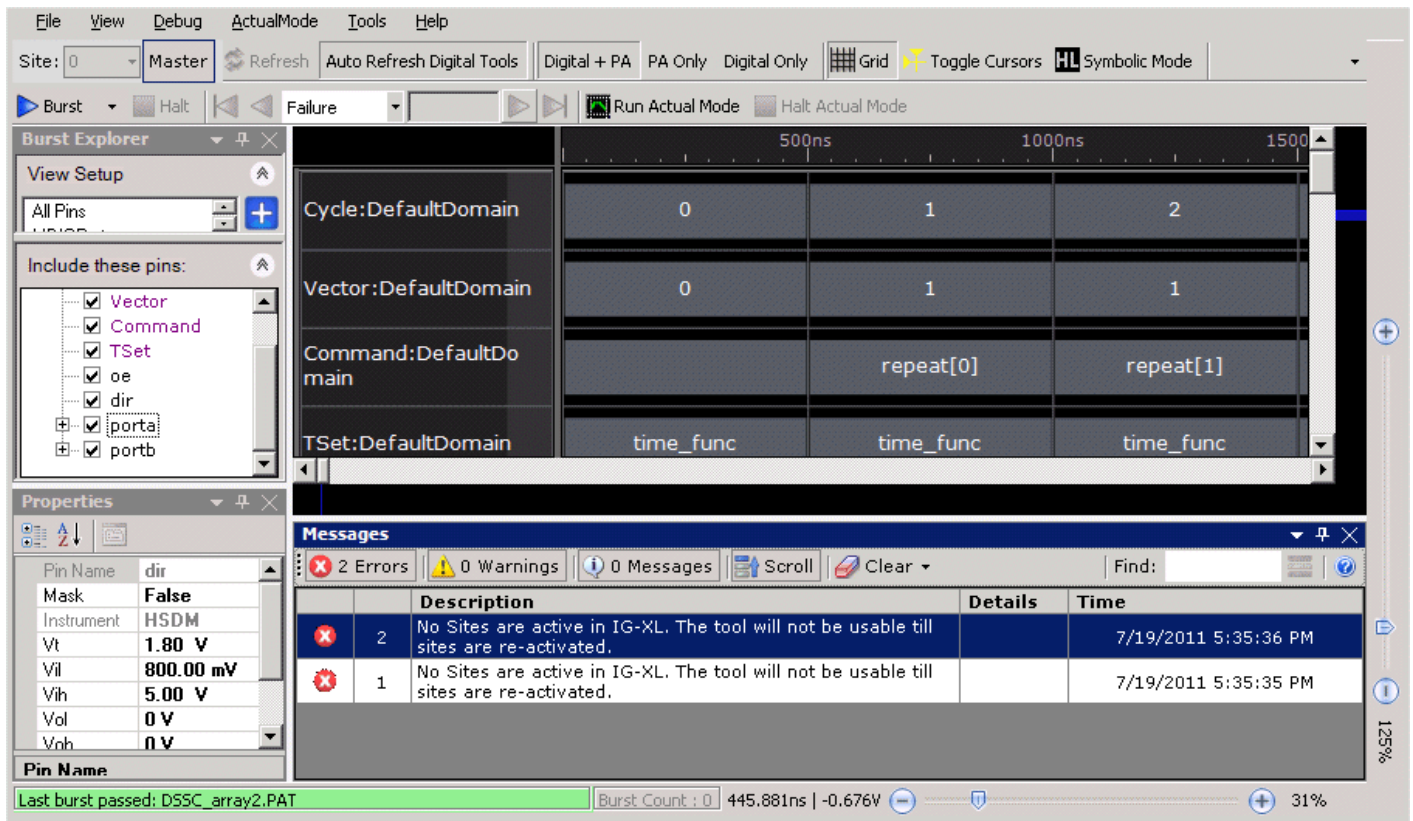
Pin Icon

To pin the panel so that it is always visible, click the pin icon. The pin icon is now vertical, pointing down:



Unpinned Icon

The panel is now pinned in place and does not hide when you move the pointer away from it:

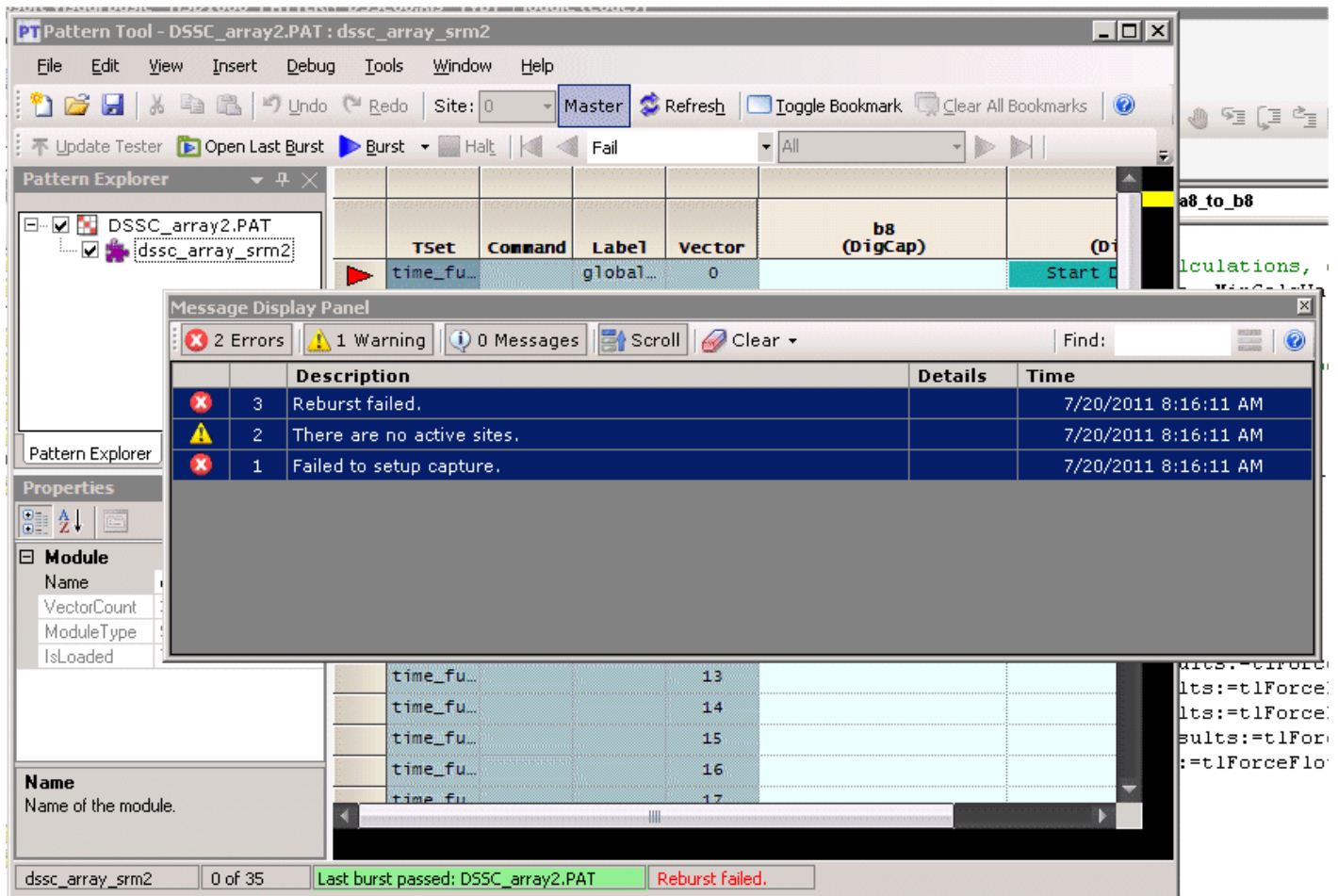


Waveform Display Showing the Messages Panel Pinned

To turn on Auto-Hide again, click the pin icon again.

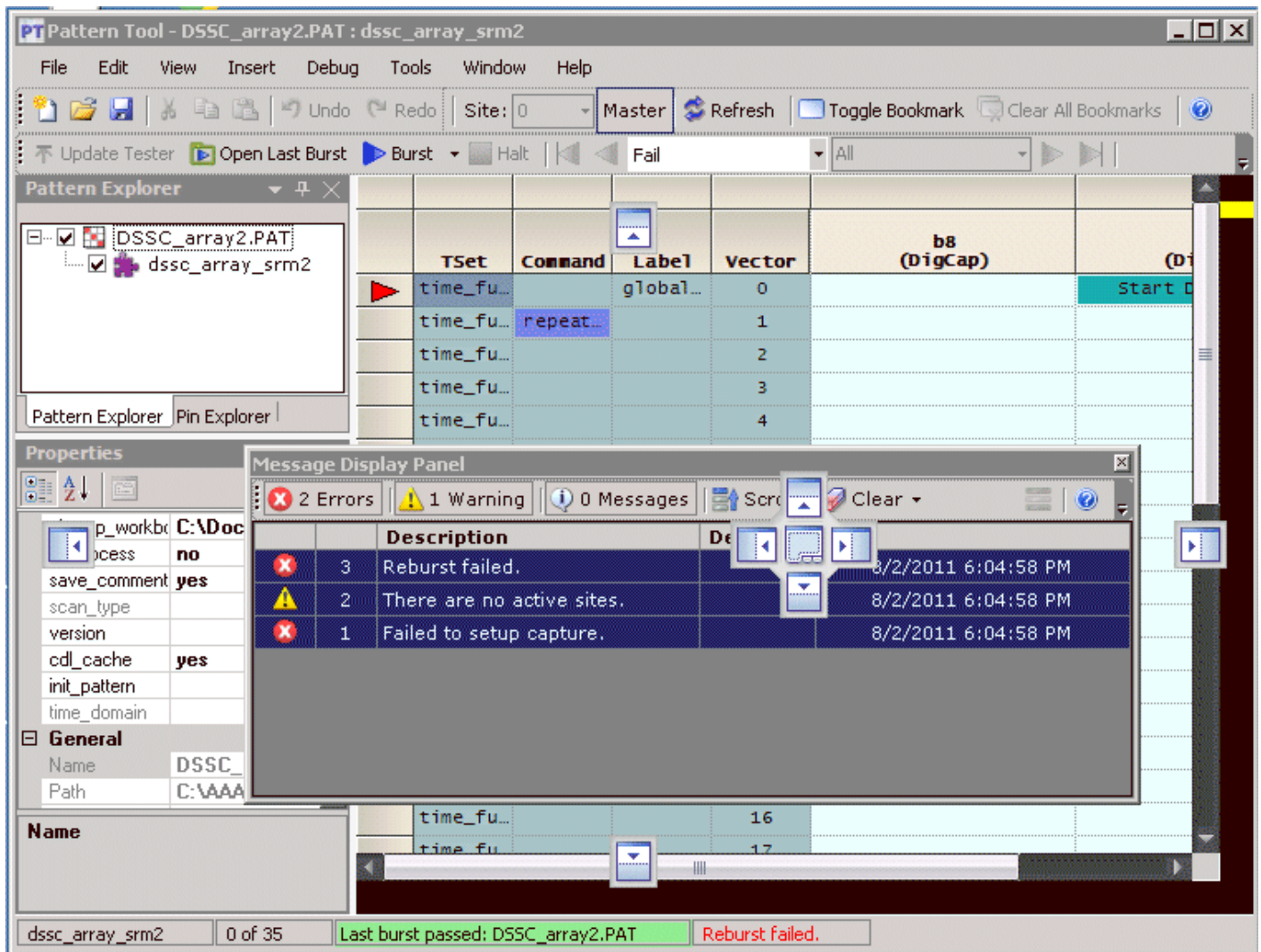
When the Message Panel is pinned, you can also reposition it by making it float or by docking it.

To make the panel float, grab the panel title bar and drag it to any position on the screen:



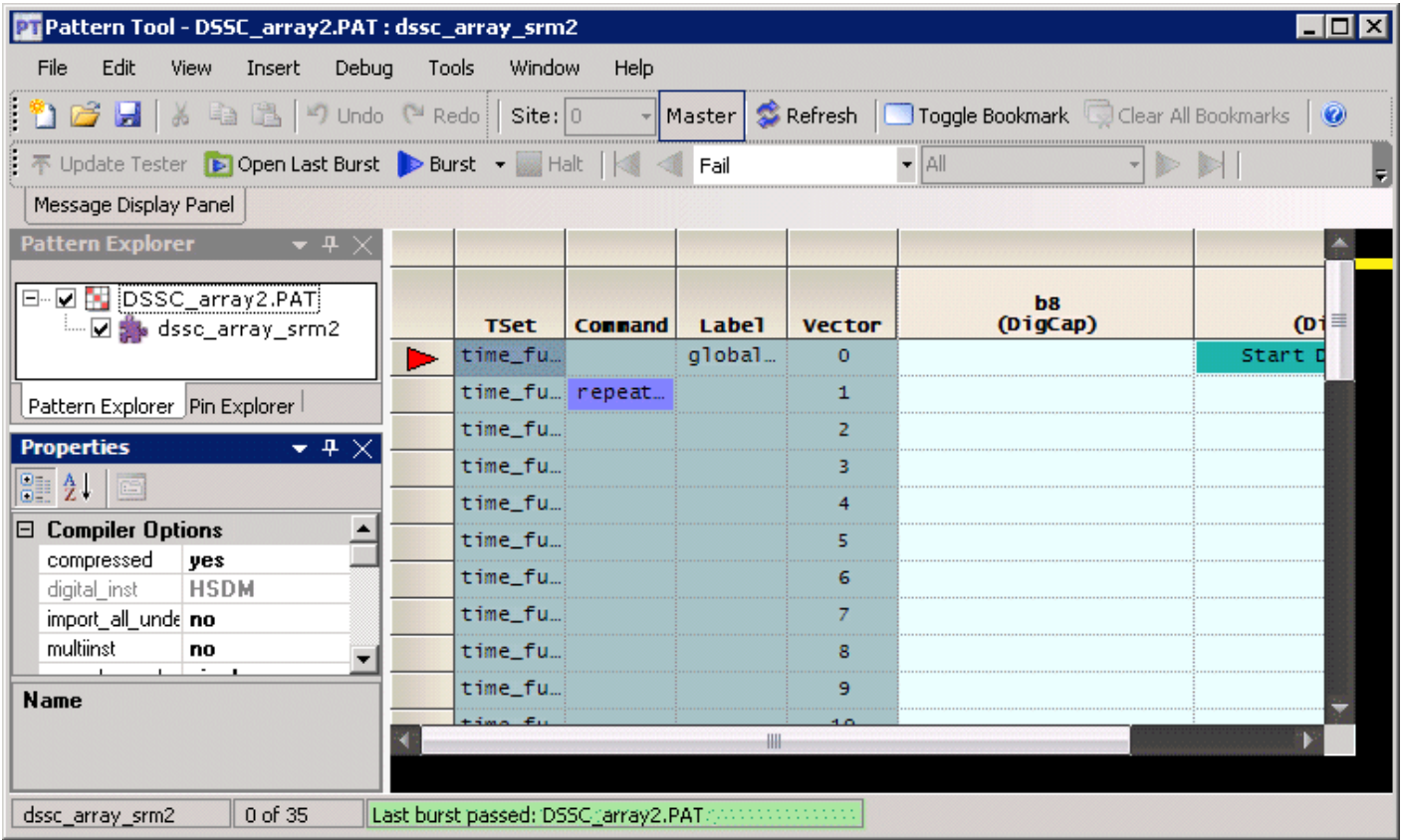
Waveform Display Showing the Messages Panel Floating

If the panel is floating, minimizing or restoring the tool also minimizes or restores the panel. When the panel is floating or pinned, you can dock it to another position within the tool by grabbing the panel's title bar and dragging to one of the indicated docking locations:



Docking the Messages Panel

If you dock the panel to a different position and then turn Auto-Hide on again, the tab appears on the side of the window at which you have docked the panel. For example, this shows the panel docked at the top:



Messages Panel Docked and Hidden

The position of the Message Panel persists between sessions. For example, if the panel is floating when you exit from the tool, it will be floating when you start the tool again.

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Using the Message Panel : [Message Panel Positioning Options](#) : Dismissing the Panel

Dismissing the Panel

When the Message Panel is visible, you can dismiss it completely by clicking the x in the upper right corner:



Pin Icon

This removes the Message Panel tab completely. To make it visible again, use View>Message Panel or Message Display Panel. If messages arrive while the panel is dismissed, the messages are saved and are displayed when you redisplay the panel.

When you close and restart the tool, the Message Panel tab is again in its previous place in the tool.



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Using the Message Panel : Controlling the Display

Controlling the Display

By default, the Message Panel displays all messages from a session. As each message is generated, it is prepended to the topic of the list, and the display scrolls so that the newly prepended message is highlighted. Each new message is numbered and is given a timestamp. Complex messages have a shortened form displayed. The default panel looks like this:

Messages				
9 Errors 0 Warnings 1 Message Scroll Clear Find:				
		Description	Details	Time
	5	Error fetching data from instrument. Lane Vector:TD1 cannot be drawn	More...	5/4/2011 8:42:19 AM
	4	Error fetching data from instrument. Lane Cycle:TD1 cannot be drawn	More...	5/4/2011 8:42:18 AM
	3	Re-bursting last burst pattern in capture all cycles mode before refreshing.		5/4/2011 8:42:11 AM
	2	No Sites are active in IG-XL. The tool will not be usable till sites are re-activated.		5/4/2011 8:41:41 AM
	1	No Sites are active in IG-XL. The tool will not be usable till sites are re-activated.		5/4/2011 8:40:56 AM

List of Messages in the Message Panel

You can control each aspect of the display using toolbar and other buttons. You click the buttons on and off. When you click a button, it appears outlined. When you click it off, there is no outline. The following topics are covered:

- Filtering Message Types
- Stopping Scrolling
- Showing Complex Messages
- Finding Text
- Selecting, Copying, and Clearing Messages

- Changing Row and Column Order

Filtering Message Types

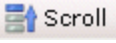
By default, the Message Panel shows all messages. You can filter out each type of message using buttons on the toolbar. To display a type of message, click the button on. By default, all three buttons are clicked on. To filter out the message type, click it off. If a button is clicked on, it is outlined. The buttons are:

 2 Errors	Display or filter out error messages.
 0 Warnings	Display or filter out warning messages.
 0 Messages	Display or filter out information messages.

Filtering hides messages without clearing them permanently. To clear messages permanently, use the Clear button. If messages of a type arrive while that type is filtered out, they are not visible until you click the message type button on.

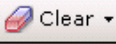
Stopping Scrolling

By default, when a new message arrives, it is prepended to the top of the list and the display scrolls so that the new message is visible and highlighted.

 Turn off scrolling by clicking the toolbar button off. New messages are still prepended to the list, but the display does not scroll to it. This is useful when you are working on resolving some error messages and do not want the focus to be scrolled away when new messages arrive.

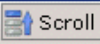
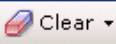
Showing Complex Messages

When a complex message arrives, a basic message is displayed along with a More button:

Message Display Panel				
 1 Error  1 Warning  0 Messages  Scroll  Clear Find:				
		Description	Details	Time
	2	Tester data not refreshed.	More...	5/4/2011 8:42:56 AM
	1	Unable to open last burst	More...	5/4/2011 8:40:26 AM

Complex Messages with More Buttons

To see details, click the More button:

Message Display Panel				
 1 Error  1 Warning  0 Messages  Scroll  Clear Find:				
		Description	Details	Time
	2	Tester data not refreshed. Is PatGen still running?	Less...	5/4/2011 8:42:56 AM
	1	Unable to open last burst	More...	5/4/2011 8:40:26 AM

Complex Message with Details Displayed and Less Button

To hide the details, click the [Less](#) button.

Finding Text

Find:  Use the [Find](#) control to do a simple text search on messages. Enter the search string into the text box. This is a simple string: wildcard characters are not supported. After entering the text, click the button.

[All rows containing the search string are highlighted and selected.](#) Find searches the complete message text, including complex messages that currently have hidden text (that is, the [More](#) button is visible). If the string is found in the hidden text, the message is expanded so that the found text is visible.

[Find](#) does not search messages of types that have been filtered out. That is, if you disable the display of [Warning](#) messages, Find does not search [Warning](#) messages for the text. See [Filtering Message Types](#).

Selecting, Copying, and Clearing Messages

The [Message Panel](#) lets you select messages and either [copy](#) or [clear](#) them.

Use the standard [Windows](#) method to select the message rows. Left-click a row and then use [Shift](#) to select a range or [Ctrl](#) to select additional individual rows. Use [Ctrl+A](#) to select all rows. The right-click context menu has these options:

- [Select All Rows](#)

- [Invert Selection](#)

The [Find](#) control also selects all message rows that contain the search text.

[Once you select rows, you can copy them to the system.](#) Use [Ctrl+C](#) or use [Copy Selected](#) from the right-click context menu.

[You can also clear the selected message rows.](#)

 [Clear](#) By default, all messages from a session are saved. Clear messages by clicking the [Clear](#) button. The options are:

- [Clear All Rows](#)

- [Clear Selected Rows](#)

[Clearing messages deletes them permanently.](#)

[Clear](#) commands are also available from the right-click context menu.

Changing Row and Column Order

You can change the row order by sorting on any column. Click the column header to sort on the column. An arrow appears on the most recently clicked column header to indicate whether the sort order is ascending or descending:

		Description	Details	Time
	2	Nothing to refresh.	More...	7/12/2011 3:50:26 PM
	1	Unable to open last burst	More...	7/12/2011 3:48:51 PM

Messages Displayed in Descending Order

You can also move columns. Click the header and drag the column to the position you want. Any reordering of columns does not persist between sessions. If you move a column, exit from the tool, and then restart the tool, the columns are in their default order.

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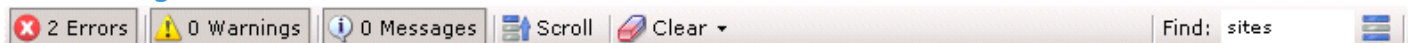
MessagePanelUsing.2.7



Using the Message Panel : Message Panel Toolbar

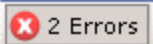
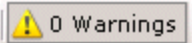
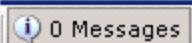
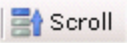
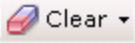
Message Panel Toolbar

The Message Panel toolbar looks like this:



Message Panel Toolbar

The individual controls are as follows:

	Displays or hides error, warning, and informational messages. By default, all types of messages are displayed. See Filtering Message Types .
	
	
	Enables or disables automatically scrolling to newly arrived messages. By default, scrolling is enabled. See Stopping Scrolling .
	Permanently deletes messages. You can clear the selected messages or all messages. The commands are also available from the right-click context menu. See Selecting, Copying, and Clearing Messages
	Finds and selects message rows containing the specified text. See Finding Text .

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